BBC LEARNING ENGLISH

Take Away English 随身英语

Return of the sleeper train in Europe

欧洲卧铺列车再度兴起

词汇：transport 交通

1 The Sun has set, and you're headed to a train station in Stockholm with your overnight bag. You **board** the sleeper train, change into your comfortable clothes, enjoy the scenery through the window for a while before laying your head down to rest. **Snoring** from the other passengers in your shared cabin delays your bedtime, but the gentle motion and **white noise** eventually send you to sleep. The next morning, just over 12 hours later, you wake up in Germany's second largest city, Hamburg. "It still sounds like a long time, but you go to sleep, and it's such a nice atmosphere on the train," says Julia Senninger, a fan of sleeper trains.

2 Before **budget airlines** made flights across Europe so quick and cheap, sleeper trains were a popular way to cover large distances without wasting daylight or paying for a place to stay. After a period of decline, sleeper trains in Europe are **making a comeback**. Belgian-Dutch company European Sleeper launched the Brussels to Milan route in September 2026 and has announced a new route connecting Belgium, the Netherlands and Sweden, scheduled to open in 2028. Other train companies Trenitalia and Nightjet have also announced plans for new international routes. Companies are rushing to meet **high demand**.

3 The rise in popularity is partly due to changing attitudes and increased awareness surrounding climate change. The **carbon footprint** of an electric-powered train is just a fraction of a flight. But **there's more to it**. Sleeper train fan Julia Senninger says trains are simply more fun. You meet more people and can have interesting conversations. Cat Jones, founder of the flight-free travel agency Byway, says, "The point of travel is the experience rather than just the arrival." So, people are **buying into** the idea that the **journey** to your **destination** is also part of the **trip**. Besides the **convenience** of starting and ending your journey in a city centre, there's also a sense of romance and adventure when you imagine **whizzing** through unknown landscapes and foreign villages while you sleep.

©British Broadcasting Corporation 2026

4 In Europe, the sleeper train comeback does not come without challenges. Competing with budget airlines, some sleeper train routes have disappeared, even while new ones have launched. Problems with **infrastructure**, cost and availability mean that the high demand for a more sustainable travel option is not currently being met.

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____
Paragraph 2 _____
Paragraph 3 _____
Paragraph 4 _____

a. The sleeper train's second rise
b. A sleeper train scene
c. Sleeper trains outside Europe
d. Why people like sleeper trains
e. Not a perfect solution
f. The downfall of budget airlines

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. What's mentioned as something that might keep you awake on a sleeper train?
   a. snoring
   b. white noise
   c. train motion

2. European Sleeper opened a route connecting Belgium and Sweden in 2026.
   a. True
   b. False
   c. Not given

3. Sleeper trains are more environmentally friendly than airplanes.
   a. True
   b. False
   c. Not given

4. Which word best summarises Julia Senninger and Cat Jones feelings about train travel?

©British Broadcasting Corporation 2026

a. efficient
b. enjoyable
c. cheap

5. The UK is investing much more into sleeper train travel than Italy.
   a. True
   b. False
   c. Not given

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

There is a **1)** _____ for sleeper trains in Europe due to an increased awareness of climate change. People also enjoy the **2)** _____ of beginning and ending a journey in the middle of the city. One difficulty train companies have is that they are competing with **3)** _____ on cost and efficiency. But fans of sleeper trains argue that it's not just about the **4)** _____, it's about enjoying the **5)** _____.

carbon footprint	**destination**	**high demand**
convenience		**board**
budget airlines		**journey**

（答案见词汇表后）

©British Broadcasting Corporation 2026

词汇表

board	登上（交通工具）
snoring	打鼾，鼾声
white noise	白噪音
budget airline	廉价航空公司，低成本航空公司
make a comeback	卷土重来，重新流行
high demand	旺盛的需求
carbon footprint	碳足迹
there is more to it	事情并没有这么简单，事实不止如此
buy into something	认同；接受；相信某个观点、想法或说法
journey	旅途，旅程
destination	目的地
trip	旅行
convenience	便利
whizz	飞驰而过，“嗖”地掠过
infrastructure	基础设施

©British Broadcasting Corporation 2026

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **b) A sleeper train scene**
Paragraph 2 **a) The sleeper train's second rise**
Paragraph 3 **d) Why people like sleeper trains**
Paragraph 4 **e) Not a perfect solution**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **a.** ***Snoring*** *from the other passengers in your shared booth* ***delays your bedtime****, but the gentle motion and white noise eventually send you to sleep.*

2. **b. False**. *Belgian-Dutch company European Sleeper launched the* ***Brussels to Milan*** *route in September* ***2026*** *and has announced a new route connecting* ***Belgium****, the Netherlands and* ***Sweden****, scheduled to open in* ***2028****.*

3. **a. True.** *The carbon footprint of an electric-powered train is* ***just a fraction of a flight****.*

4. **b.** *Sleeper train fan Julia Senninger says trains are simply* ***more fun****. Cat Jones says, "****The point of travel is the experience*** *rather than just the arrival."*

5. **c. Not given.** Train travel in the UK is not mentioned.

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

There is a **high demand** for sleeper trains in Europe due to an increased awareness of climate change. People also enjoy the **convenience** of beginning and ending a journey in the middle of the city. One difficulty train companies have is that they are competing with **budget airlines** on cost and efficiency. But fans of sleeper trains argue that it's not just about the **destination**, it's about enjoying the **journey**.

©British Broadcasting Corporation 2026